

# T1 Core Governance Concept Disambiguation Synthesis

Derivation Note T1.07 — Series T, Note #693

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## Attribution

This work derives from and formalizes commitments across the CKS theory trilogy: *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model* (Li, April 2026), *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems* (Li, April 2026), and *Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration* (Li, April 2026). It does not introduce new concepts. Its contribution is to synthesize what the six preceding T1 disambiguation notes (T1.01–T1.06) established about the trilogy's core governance concepts, to name the pattern those six notes collectively demonstrate, and to orient subsequent Series T work toward the more granular evolution concept disambiguations that constitute Phase T2.

## Abstract

The T1 phase of Series T (notes T1.01 through T1.07) addresses cross-paper conceptual ambiguity in the trilogy's six core governance concepts: conflict, governance authority, substrate, evolution and the evolution-family terms, mating, and perimeter. Each of the six preceding notes established scope-specific meanings for one concept across the three papers and the architectural commitment that the concept is one primitive operating at progressively larger coordination scopes. This synthesis note states what the six notes collectively demonstrate: the trilogy's core governance concepts are **principle-consistent**, **scope-progressive**, and **type-multiplied** — a three-property pattern that characterizes every T1 disambiguation and that applies equally to the more granular disambiguations in T2 through T5. The synthesis also states the T1 prior-art contribution: no core governance concept in the trilogy is genuinely ambiguous once its scope and type are specified, and adversarial novelty claims that rest on apparent cross-paper conceptual inconsistency fail for that reason. The note closes by framing the transition to T2, where the evolution-family concepts introduced in T1.04 at summary level receive the more granular treatment their internal complexity warrants.

## 1. Why T1 synthesis is needed

The CKS trilogy reuses a small set of governance terms across three papers at three progressively larger coordination scopes. The same word — substrate, conflict, perimeter, authority — appears in Paper 1 at cell scope, in Paper 2 at Self scope, and in Paper 3 at inter-Self and population scope. A reader encountering these terms without a disambiguation framework faces a choice between two readings: either the papers use the terms loosely,

making the trilogy conceptually inconsistent, or the terms name the same architectural primitive at larger scopes, making the trilogy conceptually unified but requiring explicit guidance on what is the same and what differs at each scope.

The T1 phase takes the second reading and makes it a formalized prior-art claim. Each of the six T1 notes established, for one concept, that the trilogy's usage is the latter kind: principled reuse at expanding scope, not loose reuse across disconnected contexts. This synthesis note states what the six notes collectively establish, because the pattern is more useful than any single disambiguation — it is the framework readers and subsequent series notes need in order to navigate all remaining T-series disambiguations without re-deriving the architecture from scratch each time.

The T1 pattern also serves a corpus-level function. T2 through T5 address more granular or cross-cutting disambiguation needs: specific evolution sub-mechanisms, substrate-mediator ladder rung transitions, trilogy-wide composition, and trilogy-wide anti-patterns. All of those phases apply the same principle-consistent / scope-progressive / type-multiplied structure. Establishing the pattern at T1 synthesis means subsequent phases can invoke it by name rather than re-demonstrate it.

## **2. The six T1 disambiguations**

**T1.01 — Conflict.** Conflict as first-class preserved state is a principle the trilogy holds consistently across all three papers. What differs is scope: Paper 1 establishes conflict preservation at intra-cell scope; Paper 2 applies the same commitment to conflicts arising within intra-Self mating operations; Paper 3 applies it to conflicts arising in inter-Self coordination approaches. The resolution mechanisms adapt to the governance authority structure at each scope, but the commitment — conflicts are preserved as explicit substrate state, not silently resolved or discarded — is invariant.

**T1.02 — Governance Authority.** Governance authority names the structural right of human practitioners to inspect, modify, and override substrate content and orchestration rules. The trilogy holds this definition consistently. What differs is the structural context in which authority is exercised: singular at cell scope (Paper 1), hierarchically tiered across cell, aspect, and Self scope (Paper 2), and extended to a home-plus-joint configuration at inter-Self scope (Paper 3). The Paper 3 joint authority over the shared substrate is additive — it supplements each participating governance authority's home-perimeter rights rather than replacing or delegating them.

**T1.03 — Substrate.** The substrate is the persistent, human-governed coordination medium whose content is the authoritative source of coordination state. The trilogy applies this commitment to six distinct architectural objects — the governance substrate at cell and Self scope, the DNA layer, the action layer, the harness substrate, the home substrate, and the shared substrate — that differ in governance layer, scope, and role. The harness substrate is the most critical disambiguation: it is a DNA-layer governance object distinct from the

reasoning-layer coordination substrate, and conflating them produces a misreading of Paper 2's instinct/reasoning separation architecture.

**T1.04 — Evolution and the evolution-family terms.** The trilogy uses four distinct evolution-family terms with non-overlapping scopes. Paper 2 introduces intra-Self evolution as the mechanism through which a Self's governance substrate changes over time via directed selection, mutation, and action-feedback. Paper 3 introduces the evolution feed as the pathway through which FAI-derived content reaches a Self's existing evolution mechanisms — a pathway object, not an additional mechanism. Paper 3 also introduces FAI-origin vertical evolution, the sub-type of evolution that is sourced from a full-aspect-integration event, and collective evolution, the calibrated-humility-governed process by which population-level governance commitments change. Evolution feed is pathway, not mechanism; this is the most consequential disambiguation in the evolution family.

**T1.05 — Mating.** Intra-Self mating (Paper 2) and inter-Self full-aspect integration (Paper 3) share the same three-variant pattern structure — a primitive that can operate as merge, supersession, or conflict-preserving juxtaposition. What differs is the governance authority scope under which the operation executes and the type of output it produces: intra-Self mating produces an offspring governance substrate within the Self's home perimeter; inter-Self FAI produces an evolution feed entry that travels through the pathway T1.04 named. Same structural pattern, different authority scope and output type.

**T1.06 — Perimeter.** The governance perimeter names the boundary within which a governance authority holds the three rights. Paper 2 introduces the home perimeter, the boundary enclosing a Self's cells and aspects under that Self's governance authority. Paper 3 introduces the inter-Self perimeter, the boundary enclosing the shared substrate during a FAI event, and the additive property: a joint authority's operation over the shared substrate within the inter-Self perimeter does not diminish any participating governance authority's rights over its own home perimeter. Three perimeter types coexist at Paper 3 scope; the additive property is the governance sovereignty protection that makes multi-organizational coordination architecturally sound.

### **3. The T1 disambiguation pattern**

The six disambiguations collectively demonstrate a three-property pattern.

**Principle-consistent.** The governance principle behind each concept is unchanged across the trilogy. Conflict is always preserved as first-class persistent state. Governance authority always names the three rights held by human practitioners. Substrate is always the persistent, human-governed coordination medium whose content is authoritative. Evolution is always the mechanism through which governance substrate content changes in a governed manner. Mating is always the pattern-structured merge primitive. Perimeter is always the boundary of a governance authority's scope. No principle is abandoned or relaxed as the trilogy expands scope.

**Scope-progressive.** Each paper extends the concept to a new coordination scope without abandoning prior scopes. Paper 2 does not replace Paper 1's cell-scope meanings; it adds Self-scope application of the same concepts. Paper 3 does not replace Paper 2's Self-scope meanings; it adds inter-Self and population scope application. The progression is additive, not substitutive — consistent with the trilogy's architectural commitment that each paper's contributions are inherited by the next.

**Type-multiplied.** Some concepts require multiple named types at larger scopes because the expanded architectural context introduces structural distinctions that do not exist at smaller scopes. Substrate acquires six typed objects across the trilogy. Perimeter acquires three named types at Paper 3 scope. Authority acquires a home-plus-joint configuration. These type multiplications are not conceptual ambiguity; they are the expected consequence of applying the same primitive to a more complex coordination context. Each type is disambiguated by its scope and structural role, and the multiplicity is itself prior-art claimed.

#### **4. The T1 prior-art summary**

The six T1 disambiguations establish the following corpus-level prior-art position: no core governance concept in the trilogy is genuinely ambiguous when its scope and type are specified. Cross-paper usage that appears inconsistent on a surface reading is principled reuse of one architectural primitive at progressively larger scopes. This position closes a family of potential adversarial claims.

An adversary who argues that Paper 3's shared substrate is a novel object unrelated to Paper 1's substrate is claiming novelty against an object that T1.03 establishes is one primitive at inter-Self scope. An adversary who argues that joint governance authority over the shared substrate is novel relative to Paper 1's single-scope authority model is claiming novelty against an authority architecture that T1.02 establishes as additive extension of the same three rights. An adversary who argues that inter-Self FAI is structurally distinct from Paper 2's intra-Self mating in a way that precludes prior-art inheritance is claiming a structural distinction that T1.05 addresses directly. In each case, the adversarial claim must address the scope-and-type specification that the relevant T1 note established — not merely the surface-level terminological difference.

The T1 prior-art summary, stated precisely: the trilogy's core governance concepts are consistent in principle and scoped in application. Apparent ambiguity resolves at the scope and type level. Subsequent T-series notes inherit this resolution and apply it to more granular disambiguation needs.

#### **5. Transition to T2**

T1.04 introduced the evolution-family terms at summary level, identifying four terms and their scope-specific roles. The summary-level treatment was sufficient to establish the T1 prior-art position — that evolution-family terms are consistent in principle and scoped in application —

but it did not descend into the internal mechanics that the evolution concept's complexity warrants.

T2 provides that more granular treatment. The T2 notes address directed selection as the governance-anchored mechanism through which evolution operates, distinguishing its intra-Self form (Paper 2) from its inter-Self analog, absorption, which is the mechanism through which an evolution feed entry is incorporated into an existing Self's governance substrate following a FAI event. T2 also addresses mutation and action-feedback as the two sub-mechanisms that operate alongside directed selection within a Self's evolution machinery, and proposing substrate as the governance-anchored vehicle through which evolution-feed content formally enters a Self's evolution infrastructure.

These T2 disambiguations follow the same principle-consistent / scope-progressive / type-multiplied pattern that T1 established. Directed selection and absorption are the same selection primitive at intra-Self and inter-Self scope respectively — consistent in principle, scoped in application, with type multiplied by the scope distinction. T2 inherits the T1 framework and applies it to the one concept family in the trilogy whose internal complexity was deferred from T1 by design.

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### Source papers

Li, W. (2026). *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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